INCH-POUND

A-A-54890
16 July 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PLUG, EAR, HEARING PROTECTION, UNIVERSAL SIZE, WITH HEADBAND

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specifications MIL-P-37564 and MIL-P-0037564A (DLA-DM), which are cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers requirements for three types of hearing protection devices with headband which provide a positive seal by distributing canal cap pressure over the ear canal for use in environments in which high intensity sound is encountered.

Salient characteristics:

Scope. Ear plugs covered by this document shall be of the following types as specified:

Type I - Ear plug without insulation on headband
Type II - Ear plug with insulation on headband
Type III - Ear plug with non-adjustable headband to be worn under the chin and behind the neck

Material. The canal caps for Type I plugs shall be made of neoprene and have a Shore Durometer A hardness value of 9 ± 1. The canal caps (pods) for Type II and Type III plugs shall be made of vinyl plastic and have a Shore Durometer A hardness value of 24 ± 2. The canal caps for all three types shall be non-allergenic and resistant to body oils and acids.

The retainers for Type I shall be made of neoprene and have a Shore Durometer A hardness value of 35 ± 2. For Type II and Type III, all hardware shall be fabricated from corrosion resisting material.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The headbands for Type I and Type II shall be made of austenitic stainless steel enclosed in a polyvinyl chloride tube. For Type II, the headband polyvinyl chloride tube shall have a layer of polyurethane foam on the surface to be in contact with the wearer. For Type III, the headband shall be made of butyrate acetate cellulose.

Design and construction. The ear plug shall consist of a canal cap or pod for each ear. Each canal cap (pod) shall fit into and seal the external auditory meatus. The canal caps shall be attached to the headband by the retainers. The Type I ear plug shall be in accordance with Figure 1-A, the Type II ear plug shall be in accordance with Figure 1-B, and Type III ear plugs shall be in accordance with Figure 1-C.

Performance. When tested in accordance with ANSI S3.19, the sound attenuation shall exceed the following minimum values:

Frequency (Hz)	Type I Attenuation (db)	STD. Dev. (db)	Type II or Type III Attenuation (db)
500	19.1	3.4	15
1000	22.6	2.8	18
2000	31.9	3.1	29
3000	35.3	2.6	36
4000	32.8	3.7	39
6000	-	-	35
8000	-	-	36

Workmanship. The ear plugs shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability. The ear plugs shall be free from objectionable odor.

Unit. Each (EA). One ear plug packaged in a sealed plastic bag as specified, constitutes one unit.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspection are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Examination. Examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one ear plug as specified. Sampling shall be inspection level II with an Acceptance Quality Level (AQL) of 1.0.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one ear plug. Sampling shall be inspection level S-1 with an AQL of 1.0.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerance specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers, Types and their respective Item Identifications are covered by this document:

NATIONAL STOCK NUMBER	TYPE	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-00-181-8058	I	PLUG, EAR, HEARING PROTECTION, UNIVERSAL SIZE, WITHOUT INSULATION ON HEADBAND
6515-00-392-0726	II	PLUG, EAR, HEARING PROTECTION, UNIVERSAL SIZE, WITH INSULATION ON HEADBAND
6515-01-059-1821	III	PLUG, EAR, HEARING PROTECTION, TO BE WORN UNDER-THE-CHIN AND BEHIND-THE-NECK

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

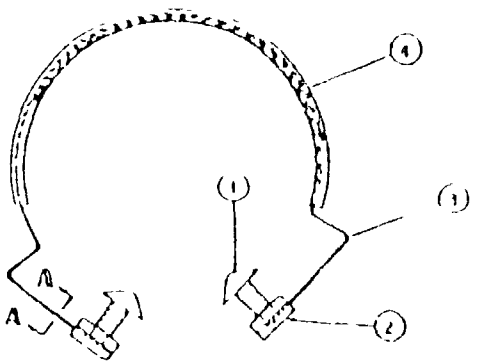
DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project Number: 6515-5512
Location: c:\word\doc\tarun\plug2\db

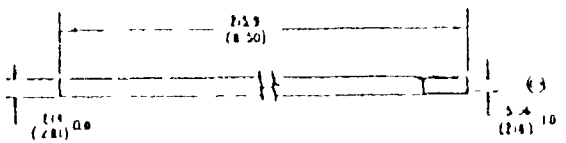
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



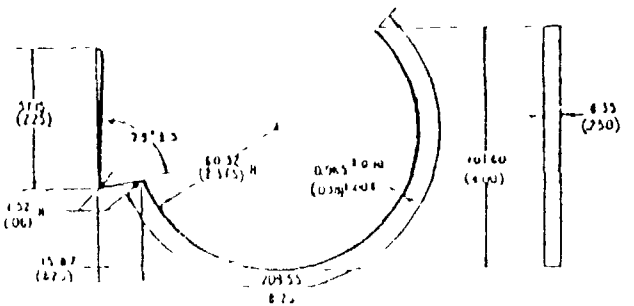
ASSEMBLY VIEW



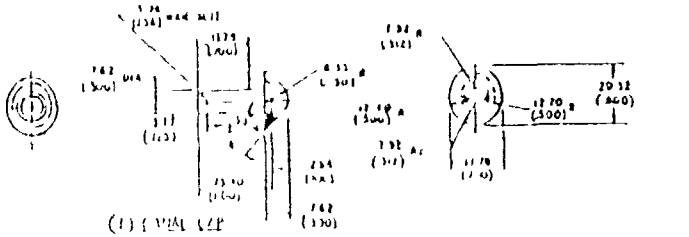
SECTION A-A



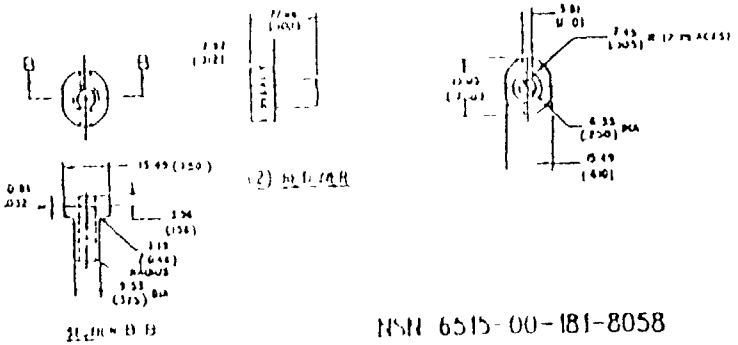
(4) HEAD BAND COVER
(TUBING)



(3) RIGHT HEAD STRAP
(SIMILAR TO BUT OPPOSITE HAND OF LEFT HEAD STRAP)



(1) EAR CAP



(2) HOUSING

SECTION B-B

NSN 6515-00-181-8058

DIMENSIONS ARE IN MILLIMETERS DIMENSIONS IN PARENTHESES ARE IN INCHES TOLERANCES	
UP TO 10 MM	± 1 MM
OVER 10 MM TO 25 MM	± 1.5 MM
OVER 25 MM	± 5 MM

A-A-54890

FIGURE 1-A PLUG, EAR, HEARING PROTECTION WITH HEAD BAND

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

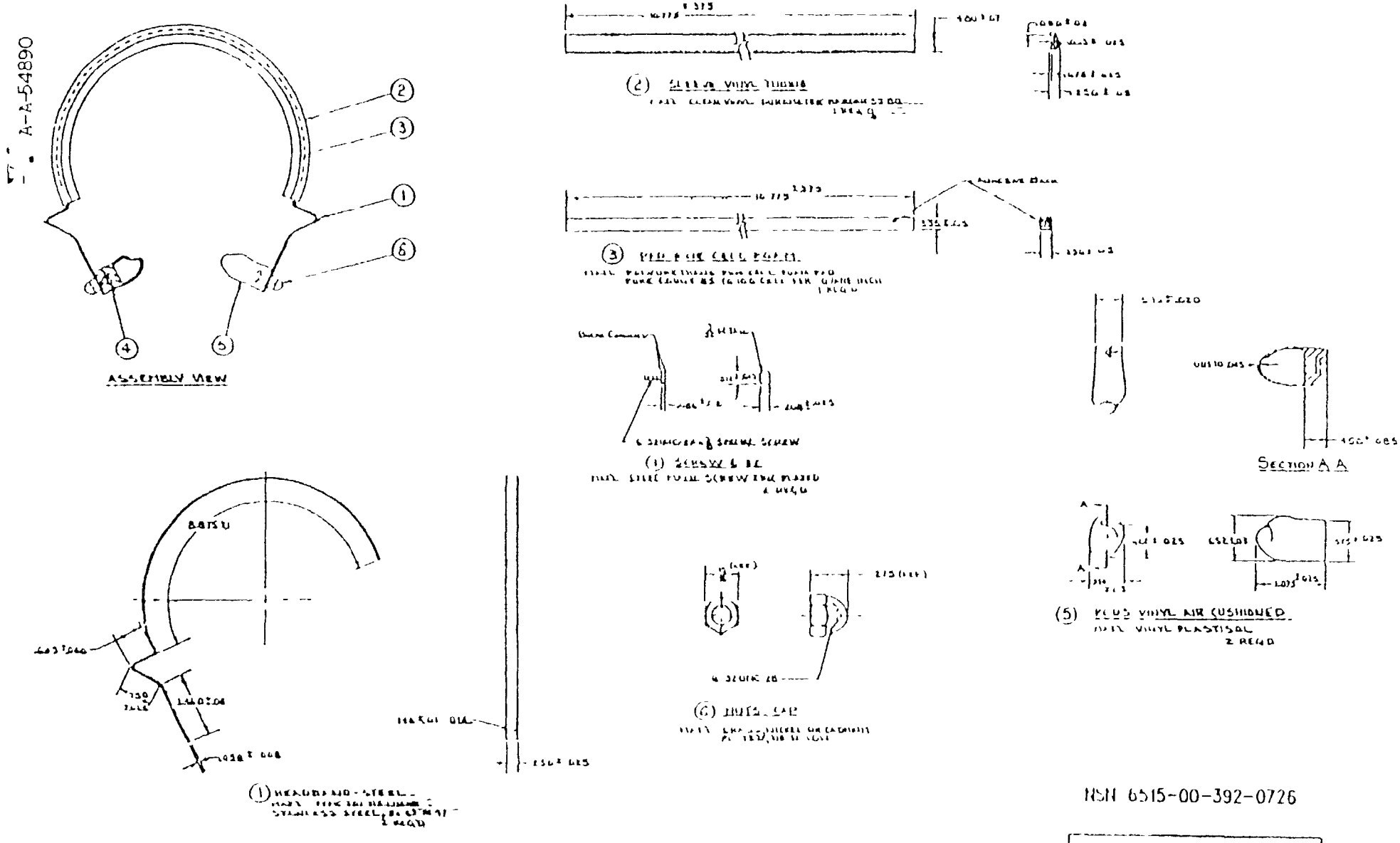
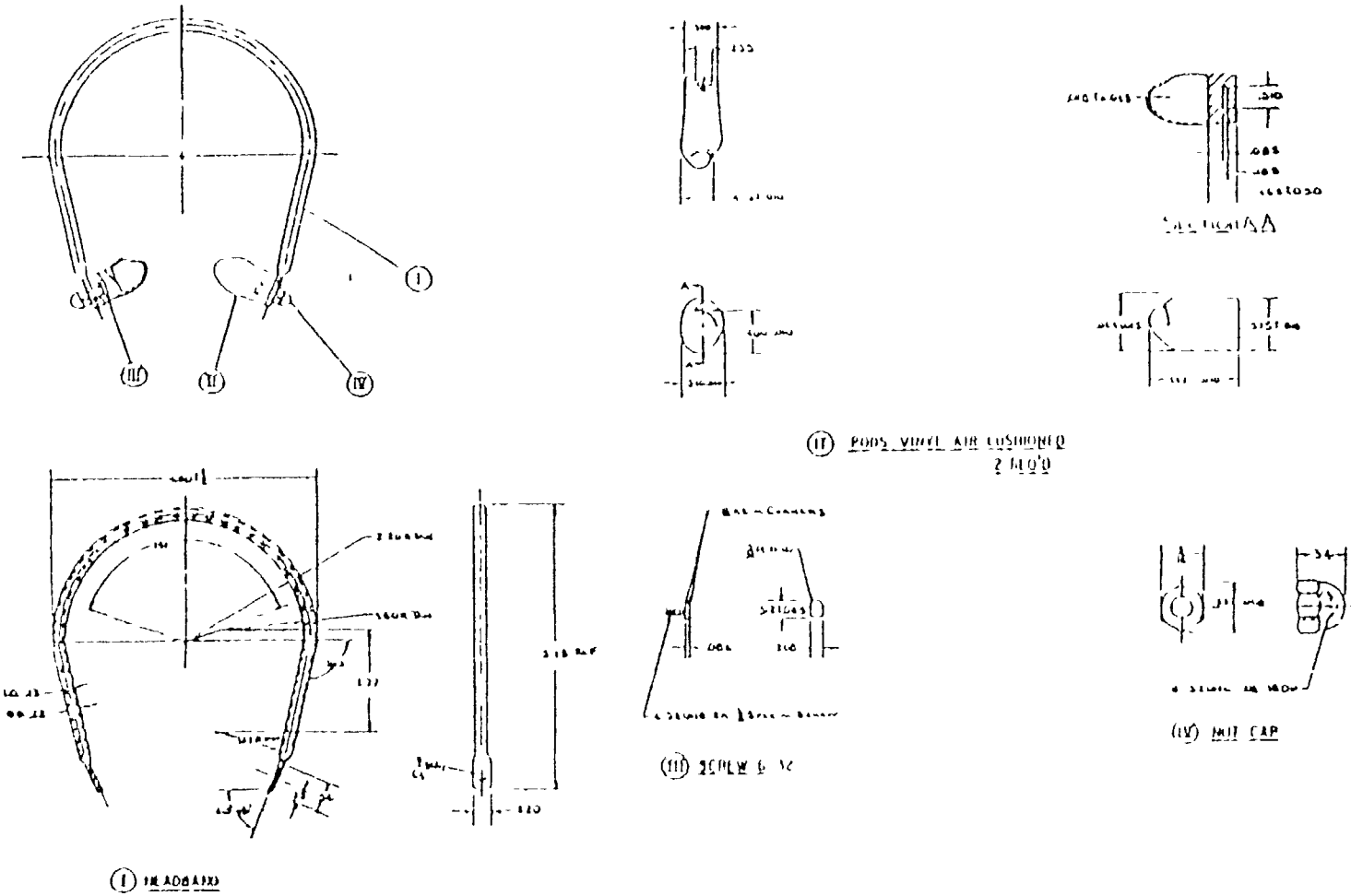


FIGURE 1-B PLUG, EAR, HEARING PROTECTION, UNIVERSAL SIZE, PLASTIC

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -7 Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



NSN 6515 01-059-1821

UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES TOLERANCES ON		
FRACTIONS	DECIMALS	ANGLES
± 1/32	± .005	± 1/2°

A-A-54890

FIGURE 1-C PLUG, EAR, HEARING PROTECTION, UNIVERSAL SIZE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER: A-A-54890	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD): 930716

3. DOCUMENT TITLE: PLUG, EAR, HEARING PROTECTION, UNIVERSAL SIZE, WITH HEADBAND

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)
	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON
Defense Personnel Support Center ATTN DPSC-MSE	(215)7372870	444-2870
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) 2800 South 20th Street Philadelphia, PA 19145	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike Suite 1403 Falls Church VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

DD Form 1426, OCT 89 — Previous editions are obsolete — 198-290

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.